TidyTuesday Week 45

Pranay Gundam

Friday 6th November, 2026

Contents

1 Weekly Summary **2**

2 Date: 2026-11-02 **3**
2.1 Raw Regression 3
2.2 Detrended Regression 5

3 Date: 2026-11-03 **7**
3.1 Raw Regression 7
3.2 Detrended Regression 9

4 Date: 2026-11-04 **11**
4.1 Raw Regression 11
4.2 Detrended Regression 13

5 Date: 2026-11-05 **15**
5.1 Raw Regression 15
5.2 Detrended Regression 17

6 Date: 2026-11-06 **19**
6.1 Raw Regression 19
6.2 Detrended Regression 21

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly edition of Two Random Economic Series Walk Into A Regression, where we throw darts at the FRED database and act surprised when they occasionally land near each other. This week's lineup includes goods-producing employment in Springfield, nursing home price indexes, boneless chicken breasts in the Midwest, and – because we contain multitudes – covered employment in Puerto Rico. As always, none of these pairings mean anything, and that will not stop me from narrating them like a sports broadcaster.

Monday gave us the single most on-brand result this project has ever produced. Springfield goods-producing employment versus nursing home prices came out of the gate with an R-squared of 0.78 and a p-value with so many zeros after the decimal point I briefly thought my keyboard was stuck. "Three-quarters of the variance explained!" I gasped, clutching my pearls. Then we detrended it, and the R-squared face-planted to a majestic 0.02 with a p-value of 0.52, which in statistical terms means "we have nothing, go home." Two things that both drifted over time, holding hands, pretending it was love. Textbook trend mirage. Chef's kiss. Tuesday's IT manufacturing orders versus Missouri bank returns pulled a similar stunt – gorgeous raw significance, then collapsed to a feeble, barely-there whisper once the trend was stripped out.

Now, credit where it's due, because a couple of these actually survived the detrending guillotine, which around here counts as front-page news. Wednesday's residential electric power prices versus food services retail sales kept a real, significant relationship after detrending (R-squared around 0.21), and Thursday's Puerto Rico covered employment versus U.S. travel services exports was even more stubborn – the raw version was limp and unconvincing, but the detrended version actually got stronger, clocking in at R-squared 0.52. A relationship that shows up more clearly once you remove the trend is the rare honest-to-goodness kind of hit this project pretends to be looking for. Friday's trade balance versus Midwest chicken breast prices also held onto significance after detrending, so apparently the price of your boneless chicken and the nation's goods-and-services balance share some faint cosmic heartbeat. I will not be theorizing further, because every theory I come up with is embarrassing.

The usual disclaimer, now engraved on my soul: these are randomly paired series with zero intended causal meaning and no rigorous statistical claim whatsoever. When something "survives detrending," that just means the coincidence is slightly more structurally interesting, not that Puerto Rican employment is secretly booking vacations. Spurious correlation is the default setting of this entire operation – the surprising weeks are the ones where literally nothing lines up. See you next week for more darts.

2 Date: 2026-11-02

Series ID: SMU25781000600000001
This series is titled All Employees: Goods Producing in Springfield, MA-CT (NECTA) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1990-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-12-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: PRGONUPIHCSA
This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Provider: Nursing Homes: Proprietary and Government Nursing Homes Price Index and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PRGONUPIHCSA	**R-squared:**	0.783
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.772
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	72.01
Date:	Mon, 02 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	4.64e-08
Time:	21:06:51	**Log-Likelihood:**	-73.979
No. Observations:	22	**AIC:**	152.0
Df Residuals:	20	**BIC:**	154.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	186.2043	11.787	15.797	0.000	161.616	210.793
value_fred_SMU25781000600000001	-2.2652	0.267	-8.486	0.000	-2.822	-1.708

Omnibus:	5.822	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.251
Prob(Omnibus):	0.054	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	4.103
Skew:	1.043	**Prob(JB):**	0.129
Kurtosis:	3.353	**Cond. No.**	333.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

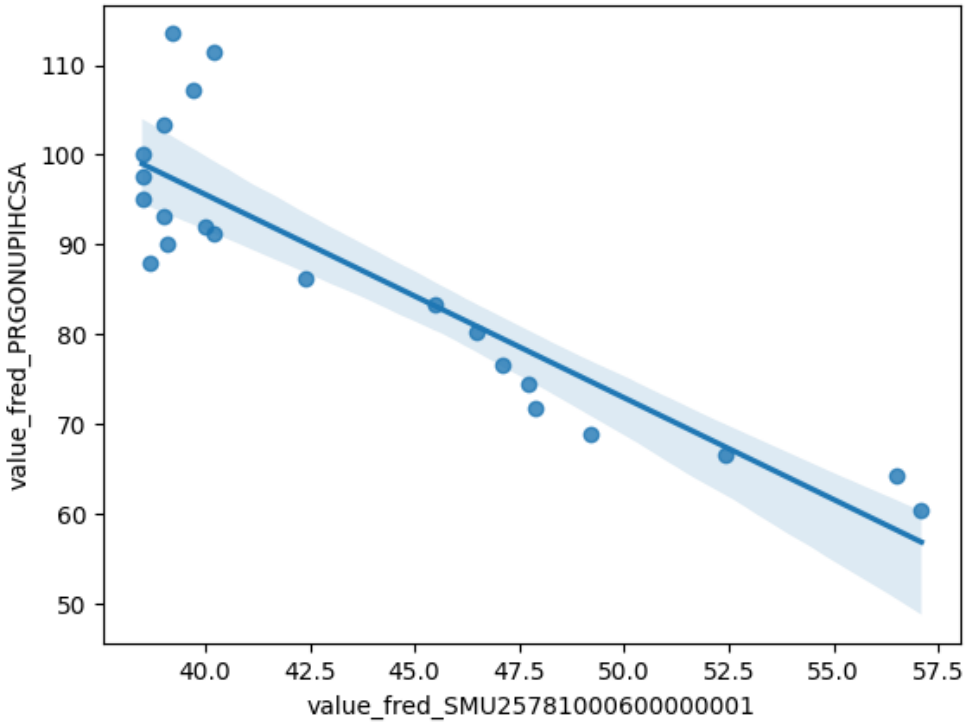


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-02

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PRGONUPIHCSA_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.021
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.028
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.4223
Date:	Mon, 02 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.523
Time:	21:06:51	**Log-Likelihood:**	-42.096
No. Observations:	22	**AIC:**	88.19
Df Residuals:	20	**BIC:**	90.37
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	4.027e-13	0.367	1.1e-12	1.000	-0.765	0.765
value_fred_SMU25781000600000001_detrended	-0.0866	0.133	-0.650	0.523	-0.365	0.191

Omnibus:	2.262	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.331
Prob(Omnibus):	0.323	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.135
Skew:	-0.097	**Prob(JB):**	0.567
Kurtosis:	1.904	**Cond. No.**	2.75

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

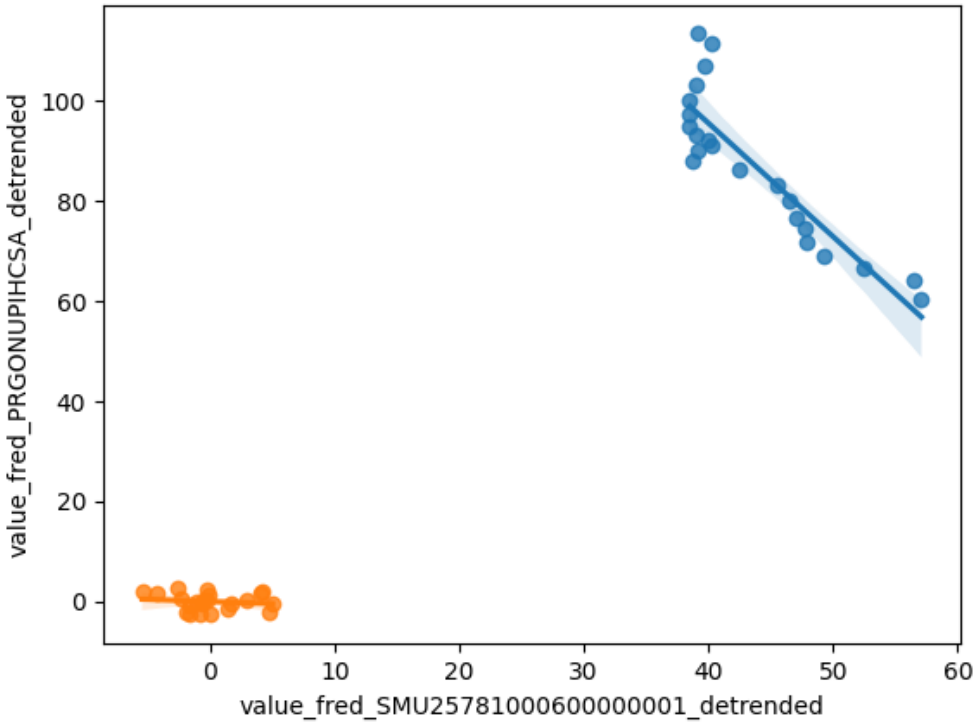


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-02

3 Date: 2026-11-03

Series ID: AITINO
This series is titled Manufacturers' New Orders: Information Technology Industries and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 14.

Series ID: MOROE
This series is titled Return on Average Equity for Banks in Missouri (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1984-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-07-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MOROE	**R-squared:**	0.135
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.128
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	17.51
Date:	Tue, 03 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	5.69e-05
Time:	18:56:19	**Log-Likelihood:**	-307.15
No. Observations:	114	**AIC:**	618.3
Df Residuals:	112	**BIC:**	623.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.9234	2.332	0.825	0.411	-2.697	6.544
value_fred_AITINO	0.0004	9.45e-05	4.185	0.000	0.000	0.001

Omnibus:	41.602	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.161
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	88.948
Skew:	-1.485	**Prob(JB):**	4.84e-20
Kurtosis:	6.147	**Cond. No.**	1.70e+05

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.7e+05. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

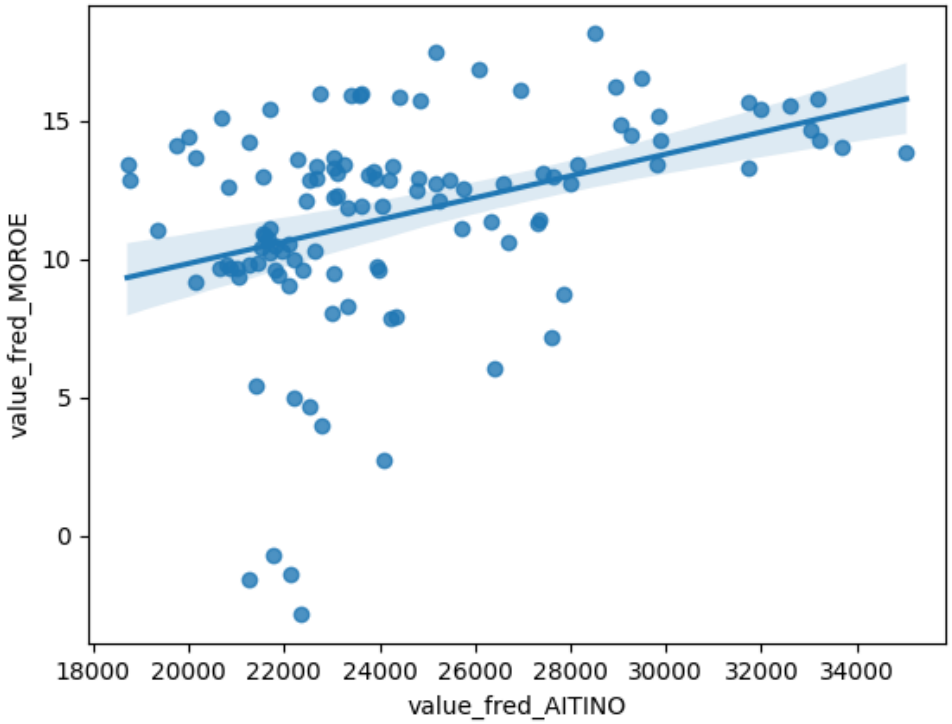


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-03

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MOROE_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.057
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.049
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	6.779
Date:	Tue, 03 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0105
Time:	18:56:19	**Log-Likelihood:**	-295.86
No. Observations:	114	**AIC:**	595.7
Df Residuals:	112	**BIC:**	601.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-7.674e-13	0.306	-2.5e-12	1.000	-0.607	0.607
value_fred_AITINO_detrended	0.0002	9.13e-05	2.604	0.010	5.68e-05	0.000

Omnibus:	60.278	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.190
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	192.530
Skew:	-1.974	**Prob(JB):**	1.56e-42
Kurtosis:	7.994	**Cond. No.**	3.35e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 3.35e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

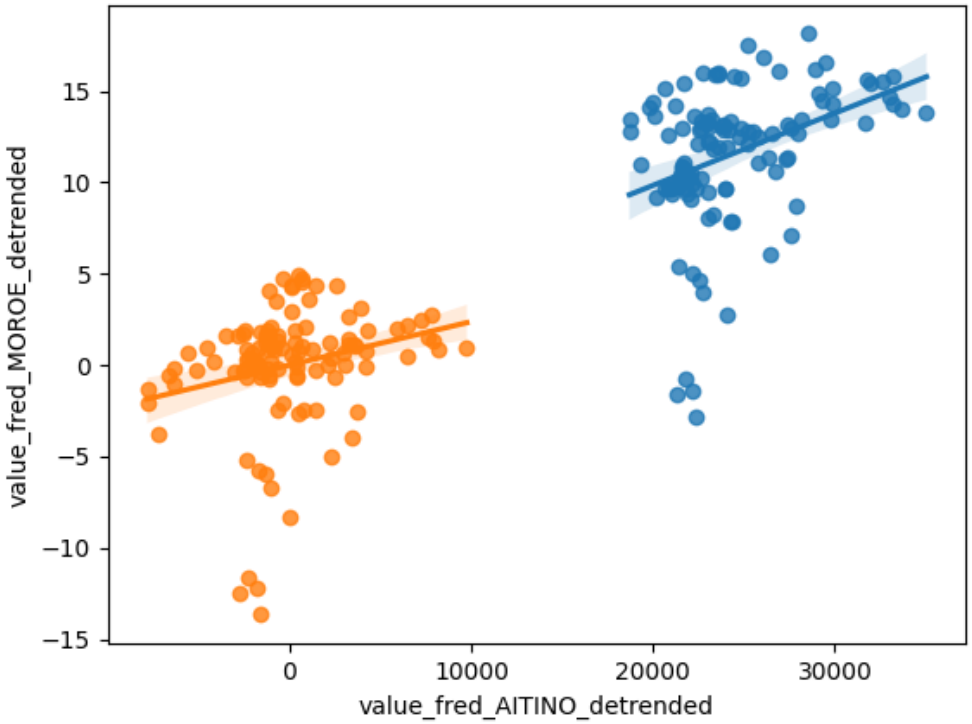


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-03

4 Date: 2026-11-04

Series ID: WPU054121013
This series is titled Producer Price Index by Commodity: Fuels and Related Products and Power: Residential Electric Power for East North Central Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2007=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2007-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: MRTSSM722USN
This series is titled Retail Sales: Food Services and Drinking Places and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01.The popularity of this series is 19.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MRTSSM722USN	**R-squared:**	0.737
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.734
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	318.7
Date:	Wed, 04 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	8.31e-35
Time:	22:07:01	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1192.6
No. Observations:	116	**AIC:**	2389.
Df Residuals:	114	**BIC:**	2395.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.164e+04	5164.973	-4.190	0.000	-3.19e+04	-1.14e+04
value_fred_WPU054121013	575.5062	32.238	17.852	0.000	511.643	639.370

Omnibus:	8.963	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.814
Prob(Omnibus):	0.011	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	10.211
Skew:	-0.481	**Prob(JB):**	0.00606
Kurtosis:	4.089	**Cond. No.**	1.25e+03

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

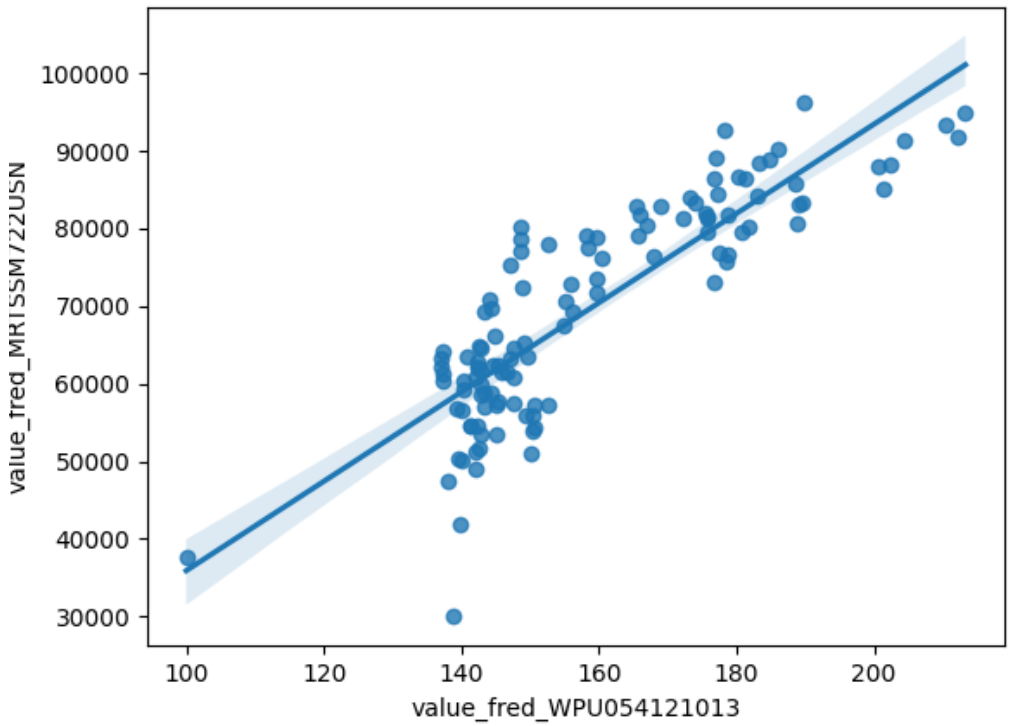


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-04

[2] The condition number is large, 1.25e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_MRTSSM722USN_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.211
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.204
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	30.56
Date:	Wed, 04 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	2.08e-07
Time:	22:07:01	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1180.4
No. Observations:	116	**AIC:**	2365.
Df Residuals:	114	**BIC:**	2370.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.527e-09	595.106	2.57e-12	1.000	-1178.899	1178.899
value_fred_WPU054121013_detrended	318.6043	57.635	5.528	0.000	204.429	432.779

Omnibus:	41.308	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.835
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	110.393
Skew:	-1.327	**Prob(JB):**	1.07e-24
Kurtosis:	6.975	**Cond. No.**	10.3

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

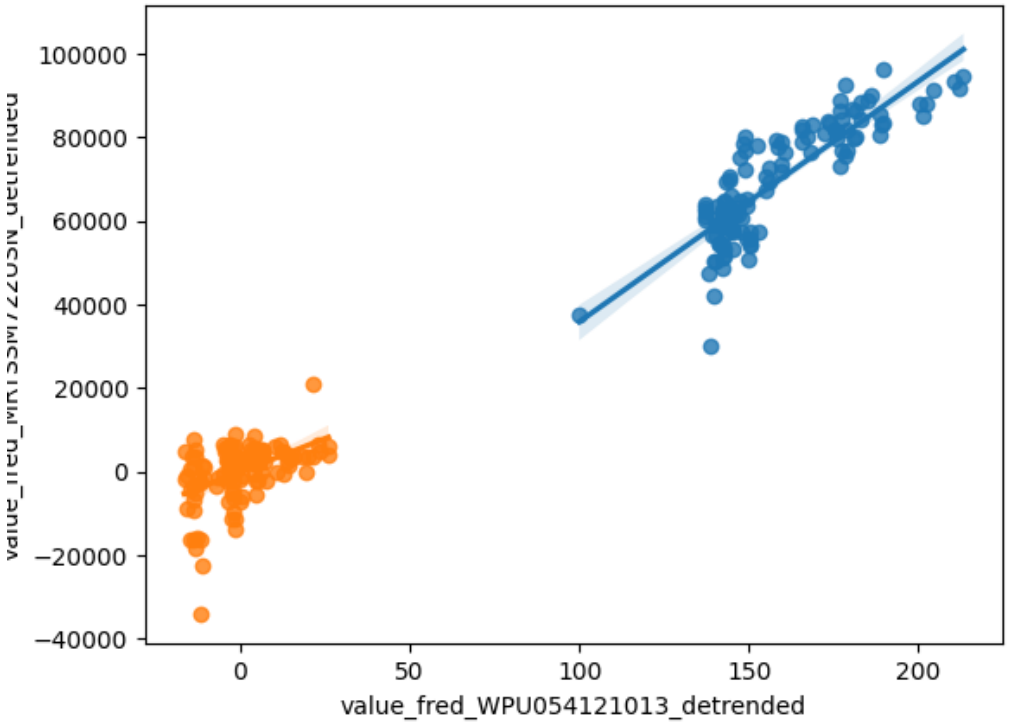


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-04

5 Date: 2026-11-05

Series ID: PRICEMPLOY
This series is titled Covered Employment in Puerto Rico and has a frequency of Weekly, Ending Saturday. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1986-02-08 and the observation end date is 2026-10-17.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BOXTVLM133S
This series is titled U.S. Exports of Services - Travel and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1992-01-01 and the observation end date is 2017-09-01.The popularity of this series is 2.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOXTVLM133S	**R-squared:**	0.064
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.042
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	2.938
Date:	Thu, 05 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0937
Time:	19:20:26	**Log-Likelihood:**	-420.46
No. Observations:	45	**AIC:**	844.9
Df Residuals:	43	**BIC:**	848.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.907e+04	6693.471	2.850	0.007	5574.413	3.26e+04
value_fred_PRICEMPLOY	-0.0121	0.007	-1.714	0.094	-0.026	0.002

Omnibus:	5.659	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.056
Prob(Omnibus):	0.059	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	2.550
Skew:	0.283	**Prob(JB):**	0.279
Kurtosis:	1.981	**Cond. No.**	1.51e+07

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 1.51e+07. This might indicate that there are
strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

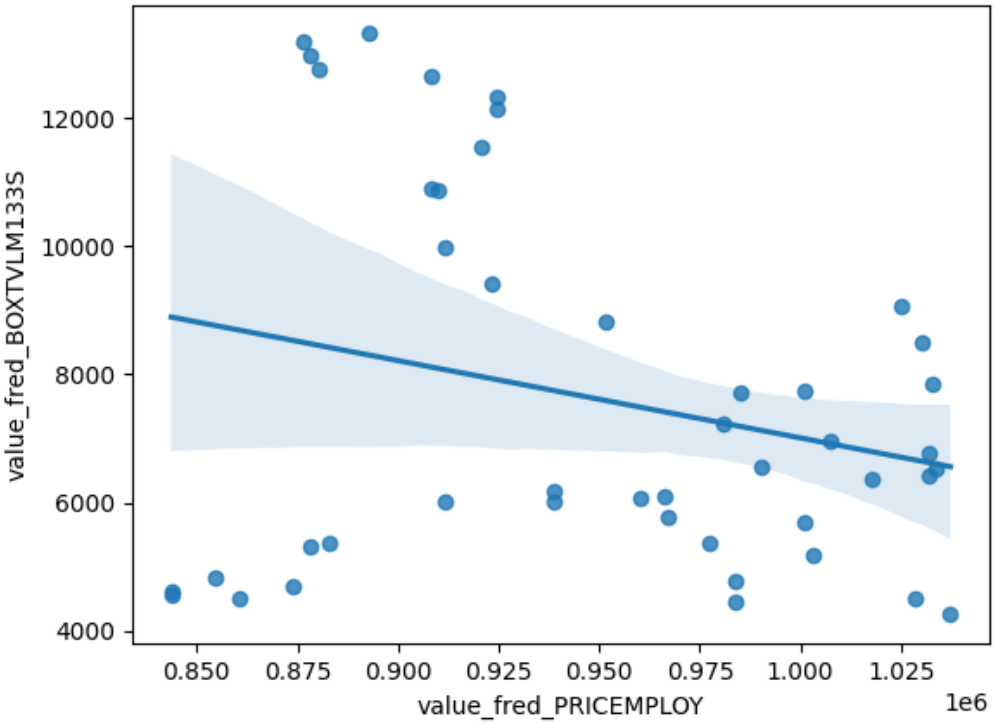


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-05

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOXTVLM133S_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.519
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.508
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	46.42
Date:	Thu, 05 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	2.40e-08
Time:	19:20:26	**Log-Likelihood:**	-369.72
No. Observations:	45	**AIC:**	743.4
Df Residuals:	43	**BIC:**	747.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.659e-10	136.526	-1.95e-12	1.000	-275.330	275.330
value_fred_PRICEMPLOY_detrended	-0.0156	0.002	-6.813	0.000	-0.020	-0.011

Omnibus:	0.541	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.520
Prob(Omnibus):	0.763	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.636
Skew:	-0.013	**Prob(JB):**	0.727
Kurtosis:	2.418	**Cond. No.**	5.97e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 5.97e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

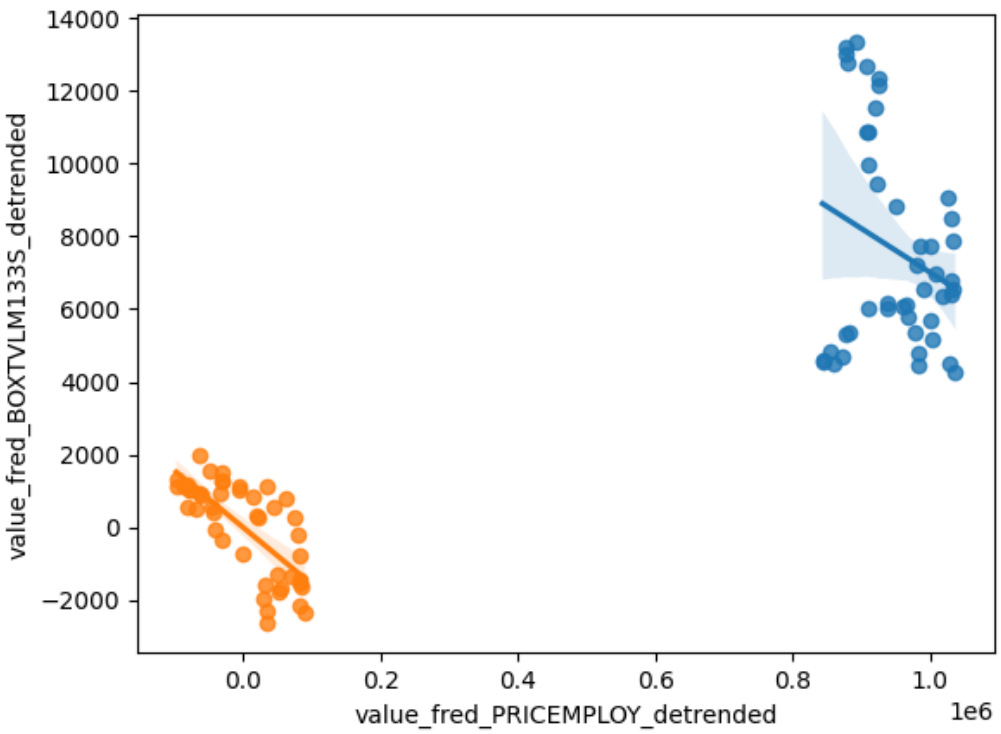


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-05

6 Date: 2026-11-06

Series ID: IEABCGSN
This series is titled Balance on goods and services and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1999-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: APU0200FF1101
This series is titled Average Price: Chicken Breast, Boneless (Cost per Pound/453.6 Grams) in the Midwest Census Region - Urban and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2006-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_APU0200FF1101	**R-squared:**	0.277
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.268
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	30.27
Date:	Fri, 06 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	4.50e-07
Time:	18:35:36	**Log-Likelihood:**	-61.425
No. Observations:	81	**AIC:**	126.8
Df Residuals:	79	**BIC:**	131.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	2.5029	0.195	12.831	0.000	2.115	2.891
value_fred_IEABCGSN	-6.612e-06	1.2e-06	-5.502	0.000	-9e-06	-4.22e-06

Omnibus:	17.392	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.410
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	20.526
Skew:	1.099	**Prob(JB):**	3.49e-05
Kurtosis:	4.119	**Cond. No.**	5.45e+05

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
[2] The condition number is large, 5.45e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

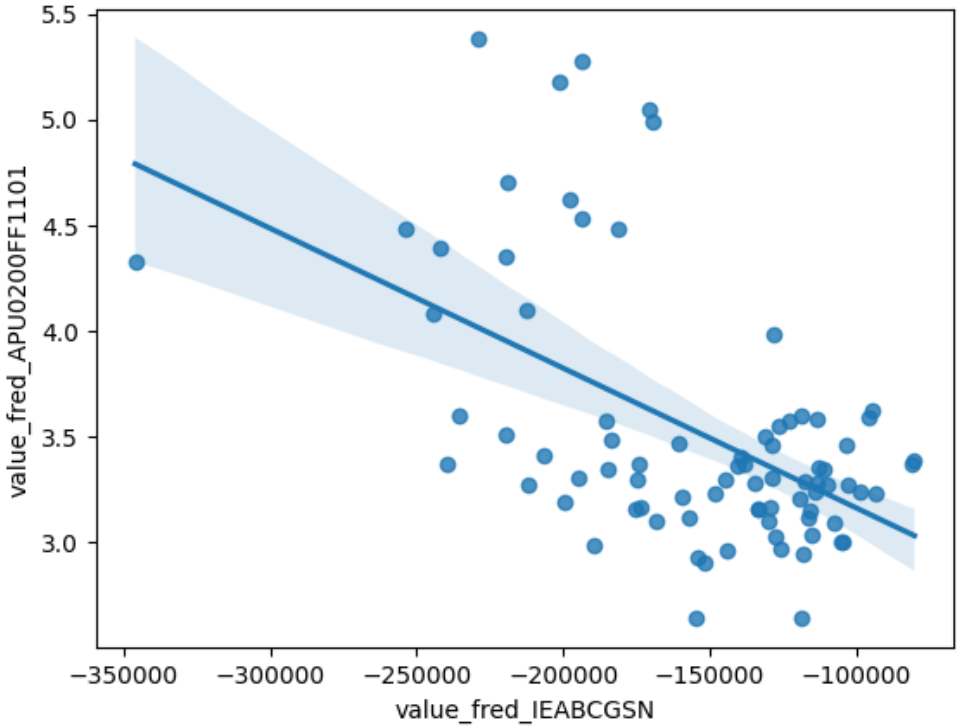


Figure 9: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-06

6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_APU0200FF1101_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.144
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.134
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	13.33
Date:	Fri, 06 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.000467
Time:	18:35:36	**Log-Likelihood:**	-54.751
No. Observations:	81	**AIC:**	113.5
Df Residuals:	79	**BIC:**	118.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	3.741e-14	0.054	6.99e-13	1.000	-0.107	0.107
value_fred_IEABCGSN_detrended	-4.522e-06	1.24e-06	-3.651	0.000	-6.99e-06	-2.06e-06

Omnibus:	6.297	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.365
Prob(Omnibus):	0.043	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	5.617
Skew:	0.545	**Prob(JB):**	0.0603
Kurtosis:	3.690	**Cond. No.**	4.32e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.32e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

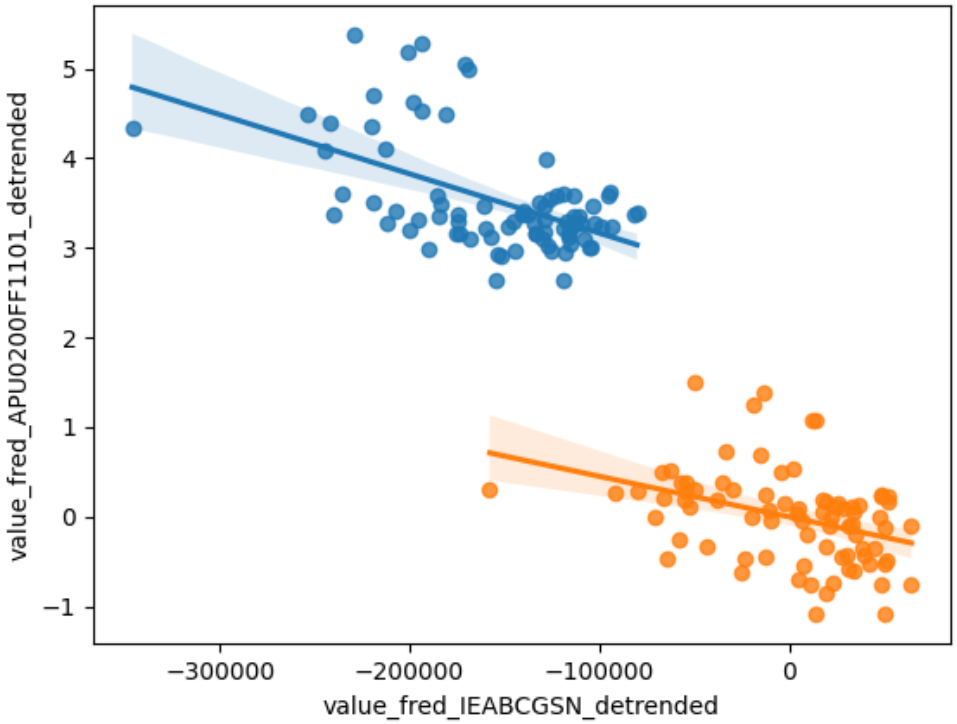


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-06